

Solicitation questions and answers

- 1) from [REDACTED]: USNCC is looking for partners institutions who can provide associates level degree plans that will also fit a built in certificate and the 15 hours of Navy transfer credits all in one degree plan, correct? Is the built in certificate mandatory or is an associates that fits the 15 Navy credits without the certificate acceptable?

Lastly, Upper Iowa University does have stand alone certificates in Supply Chain Management, Human Resource Management, and Emergency Disaster Management. These are roughly 15 hour certificate programs. Am I understanding the call for proposals correctly that USNCC is looking for standalone certificates as well?

ANSWER: USNCC is seeking partner institutions that can offer stackable credentials within associate degree programs, including pathways that incorporate the 15 hours of Navy transfer credit. Integrating a built-in certificate within the associate degree is strongly aligned with our model, as it supports incremental credential attainment.

In addition, many of these programs are also offered as standalone certificate opportunities. Providing both embedded and standalone certificate pathways is encouraged, as it enables students to achieve credentials more efficiently and supports our broader mission of lifelong learning.

- 2) From the phase I document, under General Capabilities, is this statement

TECHNOLOGY/DATA Does the institution attest that Executive Level POC listed on Page 1 has reviewed the technology requirements? (NB: should the institution be determined viable – a comprehensive plan will be part of the Performance Approach Evaluation)

What document is the “Page 1” reference referring to?

What does “NB” mean?

ANSWER:

- 3) The Performance Work Statement appears to require partner schools to offer associate degrees — a credential traditionally associated with community colleges. As the College of Professional Studies (CPS) functions primarily as a graduate and bachelor's completion institution, I wanted to confirm whether this is a core contractual requirement that would preclude our participation.

ANSWER: As outlined in the solicitation, participating institutions must be able to offer associate degrees. While this requirement is not limited to community colleges specifically, the ability to confer associate-level credentials is a core element of the contract and is necessary for participation.

4) For the Fields (programs) listed in Table 1 of CIAS – Academic Program Classification, what is the anticipated timeline for the “Future” programs, specifically:

- 1 - Leadership Communication
- 2 - AI Practitioner Certificate
- 3 – Data Visualization and Analytics Certificate
- 4 - Supply Chain Management
- 5 - Logistics

ANSWER: The programs listed as “Future” in Table 1 of the CIAS – Academic Program Classification are illustrative of potential areas of expansion rather than firm commitments with defined launch timelines. USNCC continuously evaluates program development based on workforce needs, partner capacity, and mission priorities.

Currently, USNCC already offers programs in Logistics and Artificial Intelligence, demonstrating existing capability and alignment with these fields. The additional areas—Leadership Communication, AI Practitioner Certificate, Data Visualization and Analytics Certificate, and Supply Chain Management—represent prospective offerings under consideration, with implementation timelines to be determined as requirements and resources are finalized.

5) Does the April 21st deadline apply to the Volume I, non-price proposal, only?

ANSWER: The entire proposal submission to include the Phase I form, Phase II form, Volumes I and II are due on 30-April-2026 at 4:00 PM.

6) Is there a Volume III? It is referred to on page 55 of the solicitation.

ANSWER: Any reference to Volume III is removed from the solicitation. There are only Volumes I and II.

7) Regarding the economic price adjustment clause (page 66), will the scope of the clause include adjustments made at the federal level?

ANSWER: Price adjustment will be handled on a case by case basis.

8) Will the offerors be given a range of low to high headcount or course seat projections? If not, will the offerors be expected to quote a contract maximum or just a cost per registration?

ANSWER: No. Cost per registration.

9) [REDACTED] would like to apply to partner with USNCC on this. What would be our next step? We received the email below from the [REDACTED]. We have Phase I and II forms completed and ready to send.

ANSWER: The entire proposal submission to include the Phase I form, Phase II form, Volumes I and II are due on 30-April-2026 at 4:00 PM.

- 10)** Can the deadline be extended by two weeks to **Tuesday, May 5th** to allow additional time for proposers to submit their proposals?

ANSWER: Deadline has been extended to 30-APR-2026 at 4:00 PM.

- 11)** There is a reference to the price proposal as **Volume III** on pages 55 and 65 of the guidelines. Is this a typo as it is also referred to as **Volume II** on pages 55 and 59 of the solicitation guidelines?

ANSWER: Any reference to Volume III is removed from the solicitation. There are only Volumes I and II.

- 12)** Should the offeror complete **Section B: Supplies or Services & Prices or Costs** on page 3 of the guidelines? Is this the **Attachment I “Pricing Spreadsheet”** being referenced on page 67 of the guidelines?

ANSWER: A spreadsheet will be provided via Amendment 0002 to the solicitation and will be labeled Attachment IV.

- 13)** There is a reference to solicitation pricing pages on page 56 of the guidelines where it states that they must be completed by the offeror and it may be a stand-alone Excel file attachment. Where can we find these pricing pages?

ANSWER: A spreadsheet will be provided via Amendment 0002 to the solicitation and will be labeled Attachment IV.

- 14)** What is the acronym list referenced on page 58 of the guidelines?

ANSWER: Attachment V, USNCC CIAS Definitions, is provided via Amendment 0001 to the subject solicitation.

- 15)** Can you explain what this means and what are the certification requirements being referenced: *“Unless completed in SAM, RFP Section, Representation, Certification and Other Statements of Vendors - completed by the offeror. This includes the certification requirements of FAR 52.212-3”*. This is stated on page 66 of the guidelines.

ANSWER: Institutions are required to be registered in SAM prior to award and required to respond to the questions in FAR Clause 52.212-3 prior to award.

- 16) We have relevant examples of past performance work that are similar to the scope of this solicitation, however, the work was not performed in the past five years. Can we still share this information in the Past Performance Information form to demonstrate our experience?

ANSWER: Yes. Past Performance will be evaluated in accordance with the solicitation.

- 17) Where is the “**Attachment I USNCC CIAS Checklist of the Database of Accreditation for Postsecondary Institutions**” referenced on page 61 of the guidelines? This was not included with the other attachments.

ANSWER: Attachment I is the Performance Work Statement (PWS). The reference to Attachment I stated in Question #28 above is changed to the Phase I Form, Institutional Characteristics. See question 4 of the Phase I attachment for self-certification.

- 18) On page 55 of the guidelines, there is a sentence that says, “**Each page of each copy of the non-price proposal should include the following legend: Source Selection Information- See FAR 2.101 and 3.104.**” Can you clarify what this means?

ANSWER: Each page included in the response requires Source Selection Information – See FAR 2.101 and 3.104. Any documents that do not include this shall not be evaluated.

- 19) The instructions on page 58 of the guidelines state that the “Non-Price Proposal” is limited to a maximum of 20 pages total, however, it also states that for the Academic Capabilities section, we are limited to 1 page per academic field. Are we only allowed to have no more than 2 academic fields as to not exceed the 20-page limit or are we allowed to provide more than 2 academic fields (for example, 3 academic fields so 3 pages)?

ANSWER: Academic Fields listings are not included in the 20-page limit.

- 20) Is the degree information form referenced on page 62 of the guidelines the **Phase 2** attachment? Is this to be completed and serve as the Academic Capabilities section of the Volume I Non-Price Proposal? Please clarify.

ANSWER: The solicitation is corrected to reference the Phase II USNCC Academic Program Classification form. This Form is part of Volume I submission. and page count limitation.

- 21) **Minimum Technical Capability at Award:** Can you confirm the minimum required data-sharing capability at the time of award? Specifically, is secure SFTP/CSV exchange acceptable initially if the institution can transition to API-based automation within the required implementation timeline?

ANSWER: Yes, SFTP/CSV exchange is acceptable initially with the intention of transitioning to API.

- 22) **Tier Classification Impact:** If an institution is initially classified as Tier 2, does this affect award consideration, or only implementation timing and initial enrollment capacity?

ANSWER: ?

23) NAV 101–105 ACE Status: Can you confirm whether the current NAV 101–105 courses remain aligned with the versions previously reviewed by ACE, and whether USNCC plans to resubmit these courses for updated ACE recommendations?

ANSWER:

NAV 101–105 courses remain aligned with the versions previously reviewed by ACE, and USNCC does not plan to resubmit them at this time. Credit recommendations are understood to be valid for up to 10 years absent substantive changes; USNCC is working with ACE to resolve the 2024 expiration discrepancy. In the interim, partner institutions may proceed with evaluation using current course materials, and existing ACE guidance remains applicable where training aligns.

24) ACE Expiration and Institutional Evaluation: We understand that the prior ACE credit recommendations for NAV 101–105 expired in 2024. In the absence of current ACE recommendations, are partner institutions proceeding with internal course evaluation using current syllabi and materials for articulation purposes, or does USNCC plan to provide updated ACE-aligned guidance?

ANSWER:

NAV 101–105 courses remain aligned with the versions previously reviewed by ACE, and USNCC does not plan to resubmit them at this time. Credit recommendations are understood to be valid for up to 10 years absent substantive changes; USNCC is working with ACE to resolve the 2024 expiration discrepancy. In the interim, partner institutions may proceed with evaluation using current course materials, and existing ACE guidance remains applicable where training aligns.

25) State Availability Expectations: Does USNCC expect partner institutions to offer all proposed programs in all 50 states, or is partial state availability acceptable if clearly identified?

ANSWER:

USNCC seeks partners capable of supporting a geographically dispersed, globally available Naval student population. While broad availability is strongly preferred, institutions may propose programs with partial state availability if limitations are clearly identified.

26) 1. To confirm our understanding, what is due on April 21, 2026, is *Volume I - Non-Price Proposal, Phase I Institutional Characteristics* only, correct? As per RFP N0018926RB002 page 60 of 77:

The selection of offerors for award will be conducted in two Phases. Phase I will consist of evaluation of the **Institutional I Characteristics**. Offerors who are determined to be Acceptable upon review of the **Institutional Characteristics** shall move on to Phase II. Offerors who are not determined to be Acceptable in Phase I will be notified that their proposal is no longer eligible for award and will not be included in the Phase II evaluation. Phase II will consist of the evaluation of Performance Approach, Academic Capabilities, Past Performance, and price. Phase II will consist of the evaluation of Performance Approach, Academic Capabilities, Past Performance, and price. The non-price evaluation factors will be considered significantly more important than price. The non-

And page 74 of 77:

The selection of offerors for award will be conducted in two Phases. Phase I will consist of evaluation of the Institutional Characteristics. Offerors who are determined to be Acceptable upon review of the Instructional Characteristics shall move on to Phase II. Offerors who are not determined to be Acceptable in Phase I will be notified that their proposal is no longer eligible for award and will not be included in the Phase II evaluation. Phase II will consist of the evaluation of Performance Approach, Academic Capabilities, Past Performance, and price. The non-price will be considered significantly more than price. Within the non-price proposal, Performance Approach, Academic Capabilities, and Past Performance are equally weighted. The Government's best-value award decision will be based upon the factors evaluated in Phase II.

ANSWER: The entire proposal submission package is due on 30-April-2026 at 4:00 PM.

Page 74-77 - entire proposal package is due – Phase I along with Proposal submission with Phase II.

- 27) Is there anything else we should review / make sure to include in the contract application by the deadline of April 21, 2026? When are the due dates for the Volume I, Phase II and Volumes II-III?

ANSWER: The entire proposal submission including the Phase I form, Phase II form, Volumes I and II are due on 30-April-2026 at 4:00 PM.

- 28) Where can I find the “Attachment I, USNCC CIAS Checklist of the Database of Accreditation for Postsecondary Institutions” listed on page 61 of 77 of the guidelines, as the Attachment I listed on the webpage (pictured below) is another document, not the one named “USNCC CIAS Checklist of the Database of Accreditation for Postsecondary Institutions”?

■ Attachments/Links	
Links	
Link	Updated Date
N0018926R0594_Phase_2.pdf	Mar 20, 2026
N0018926R0594_Phase_1.pdf	Mar 20, 2026
N0018926R0594_Past_Performance_Information_Form.docx	Mar 20, 2026
N0018926R0594_Attachment_III.pdf	Mar 20, 2026
N0018926R0594_Attachment_II.pdf	Mar 20, 2026
N0018926R0594_Attachment_I.pdf	Mar 20, 2026
N0018926R0594_Addendum_IV.pdf	Mar 20, 2026
N0018926R0594_Addendum_III.pdf	Mar 20, 2026
N0018926R0594_Addendum_II.pdf	Mar 20, 2026
N0018926R0594_Addendum_I.pdf	Mar 20, 2026
N0018926R0594_N0018926RB002.pdf	Mar 20, 2026

ANSWER: Attachment I is the Performance Work Statement (PWS). The reference to Attachment I stated in Question #28 above is changed to the Phase I Form, Institutional Characteristics. See question 4 of the Phase I attachment for self-certification.

- 29)** Where can I find the Attachment I-“Pricing Spreadsheet” listed on page 65 of 77? If there is not a specific Excel template we need to use, is there a budget format you prefer? Again, the Attachment I listed on the webpage (pictured above) is another document, not the one named “Pricing Spreadsheet”.

ANSWER: A spreadsheet will be provided via Amendment 0002 to the solicitation and will be labeled Attachment IV.

- 30)** Sometimes the guidelines list the “Non-Price Proposal” as Volume I or Volume II, and sometimes “Price Proposal” as Volume II or Volume III. Which name is the correct one/should we be using?

ANSWER: Any reference to Volume III has been removed from the solicitation.

- 31)** What is meant by “2. A completed and signed page 1 of the most current version of the solicitation and any amendments” as listed on page 66 of 77?

ANSWER: The signature block 30 on the solicitation and the signature block on page 1 of any amendment shall be signed.

- 32)** please clarify whether the full proposal is due on April 21, or if only the Phase I Institutional Characteristics document is required at that time?

Specifically, we are trying to determine if we should submit just the Phase I materials, or the entire proposal package, including all contents of Volume I (both Phase I and Phase II sections—Performance Approach, Academic Capabilities, and Past Performance) along with Volume II (Price Proposal).

ANSWER: The entire proposal submission, Volumes I and II, are due on 30-April-2026 at 4:00 PM. The Phase I and Phase II forms are part of the Volume I submission.

- 33)** I see a response date of 4/21 required. Do we need to divulge our interest by this date or are you requiring the Phase 1 document submission by this date?

ANSWER: The entire proposal submission, Volumes I and II, are due on 30-April-2026 at 4:00 PM. The Phase I and Phase II forms are part of the Volume I submission.

- 34)** The Performance Work Statement appears to require partner schools to offer associate degrees — a credential traditionally associated with community colleges. As the College of Professional Studies (CPS) functions primarily as a graduate and bachelor's

completion institution, I wanted to confirm whether this is a core contractual requirement that would preclude our participation.

ANSWER: As outlined in the solicitation, participating institutions must be able to offer associate degrees. While this requirement is not limited to community colleges specifically, the ability to confer associate-level credentials is a core element of the contract and is necessary for participation.

35) For submission method, is it a single PDF file for all or is one file per volume, per phase? Any naming conventions required?

ANSWER: One file per volume. Naming convention example: *SCHOOL NAME_N0018926RB002_Volume II_PRICED FILE*

36) For the required attachments (accreditation forms, past performance, etc.), are those to be filled out and submitted as-is or incorporated into the narrative.

ANSWER: The Phase I and Phase II forms to be completed by Offerors are part of Volume I and are included in the page limitation count in accordance with the solicitation instructions.

37) Are there a maximum number of programs allowed?

ANSWER: no

38) The solicitation says offerors shall submit proposals in two separate volumes, then describes Volume I as Non-Price and Volume II as Price, but in the same section it also says the non-price volume must exclude pricing that would reveal the total pricing detailed in "Volume III." Can you clarify what volume III is and where it goes?

ANSWER: Any reference to Volume III is removed from the solicitation. The priced volume refers to Volume II.

39) The accreditation checklist is required, but the actual checklist attachment appears to be missing from the package you uploaded. On page 61, the solicitation says the offeror shall certify it is included in the Database of Accredited Postsecondary Institutions and Programs and shall complete "Attachment I, USNCC CIAS Checklist of the Database of Accreditation for Postsecondary Institutions." But the uploaded "Attachment I" is the PWS, not an accreditation checklist.

ANSWER: Requires correction in the PWS. - this is on question 4 of the Phase I attachment

40) For the Past Performance on pg. 63 of the solicitation, is that only for prior contracts that we would have had with the Navy?

ANSWER: no

41) The page-limit rules do not clearly say whether required forms included inside Volume I count against the factor page limits.

The solicitation requires completion of the Phase I institutional characteristics form, degree information form for academic capabilities, and past performance form. But the instructions do not clearly state whether those required forms count inside the 20-page Volume I maximum and inside the sub-limits for each factor, or whether completed forms are treated as exempt exhibits.

ANSWER: Phase I and Phase II forms to be completed by Offerors are part of Volume I and will be included in the page limitation count.

42) If programs are selected, when does the Navy anticipate program instruction to begin.

ANSWER: Program start timelines will vary based on partner institution readiness and the evolving needs of the Naval services. USNCC will coordinate with selected partners to determine appropriate launch dates.